



МИНИСТЕРСТВО ИНОСТРАННЫХ ДЕЛ

ПРИВИЛЕГИРОВАННЫЕ ИНСТРУКЦИИ

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS

**Ministry of Foreign Affairs
RUSSIAN FEDERATION**



МИНИСТЕРСТВО ИНОСТРАННЫХ ДЕЛ РОССИЙСКОЙ ФЕДЕРАЦИИ

MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS
RUSSIAN FEDERATION

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principles

- The Russian Federation rejects any effort to create regional coordinating organizations that do not include Russia. This is a **Red Line**. Should any such organizational structure be discussed at the summit, report back to the Foreign Minister immediately after collecting as much information as possible regarding where nations' interests lie in this scheme. Determine what incentives are being offered by the nations backing this proposal.
- China is a strategic ally, but also an economic competitor. Any oil, natural gas, minerals, or metals trade deals pursued bilaterally or multilaterally with China that do not include us as the origin nation of these natural resources, or as a partner in any such trade arrangement, is to be opposed, aggressively. This is a **Red Line**.
- The Collective Security Treaty Organization (CSTO) is vital to our national security interests. Should Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, or Tajikistan give any indication they may pause participation in the treaty, or withdraw from the treaty, collect all available information regarding the catalyst for this decision and report back to the Foreign Minister immediately. While a **Red Line** for us, this situation must be handled delicately at top levels of diplomacy.
- Any agreements crafted by the attendees that supplant us as the security guarantor in Central Asia are to be opposed. This is a **Red Line** for Moscow. The delegation is directed to pressure our three CSTO allies with sanctions should they entertain creating new security organizations that do not include us or establish China as the primary leader of the organization.

Principle Negotiation Positions

These positions are to be presented openly and publicly to all attendees. However, the delegation should pursue the specific items outlined below, either bilaterally or multilaterally, and should ensure Uzbekistan's red lines are not crossed in any diplomatic agreements that might be presented, discussed, or aggressively pursued.

- We support a peaceful, comprehensive solution to the crisis at hand regarding border disputes and water resources. We reject the need for any nation in the region to resort to the use of force to resolve this issue.
- We are open to formal dialogue regarding natural resources across Central Asia and is interested in working collaboratively with our neighboring nations to find optimal ways to use those resources to better the lives of all people in the region.
- We support economic integration and is open to proposals from neighboring nations regarding lowering trade barriers, increasing export of Russian-made products

(agricultural products, minerals, oil, and natural gas), and increasing imports from all nations in the region interested in free trade. We are also open to enhancing and expanding the Eurasian Economic Union and would welcome Tajikistan and Uzbekistan into that trade relationship.

- Our national security is imperative. Hence, negotiation of security arrangements that support Russia's inherent right to self-defense and maintenance of territorial integrity will be entertained. The delegation does not have authority to enter into binding agreements in this regard, but possible bilateral or multilateral security arrangements and information regarding broad points that might be part of such agreements acquired during the negotiations is strongly encouraged.

These positions are to be held throughout the summit but are not to be presented openly to any other delegation unless otherwise directed.

- A focus for the summit is to address border disputes between Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, and Uzbekistan. We insist the borders remain as they are today. Altering the borders is a **Red Line** for us and should be opposed with vigor but without embarrassing the Russian Federation through word or deed in undermining any move toward border demarcation changes. There is the possibility that some sort of monitoring mission might be proposed for the Fergana Valley. We are not opposed to such a mission if we are a primary leader of that mission as two of the three nations of concern are members of the CSTO. Russia's duties as guarantor of the CSTO members' territory will not be abrogated.
- We will not expand any intelligence sharing agreements with any nation attending the summit. However, if India is willing to share intelligence on Chinese activities in Central Asia, further dialogue on these points would be of interest and formal arrangement is a possible outcome. The delegation may privately communicate this message to the Indian delegation. No discussions of these possibilities will take place except in bilateral discussions. No other nations may know about this initiative.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted to the office of the Foreign Minister.

General: The delegation will work closely with and support the UN Special Representative of the Secretary-General's efforts to mediate this crisis. The delegation is directed to collect all available information about the negotiating positions of the other countries at the summit. Where possible, ascertain the other nation's flexible areas and try to bend the countries toward agreeing to Russian interests. The end goal of this summit is for Russia to reestablish influence, reduce tensions, and set conditions allowing for subsequent bilateral engagement between the Russian Foreign Ministry and Central Asian nations to further Russian interests in our near abroad.

KAZAKHSTAN

Our near abroad is of vital importance to our nation's national security interests. Border security means national security, and the internal security of Kazakhstan must remain robust to ensure Russia remains secure. The delegation is directed to negotiate stronger

border security cooperation between us and Kazakhstan, which must include greater oversight and shared information on all oil, natural gas, minerals, and metals exported from or imported into Kazakhstan from our mutual neighbors in the region. It is particularly important to understand what resources are being sent to China from any nation in Central Asia, even with projects under China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) already approved by Central Asian partners. Kazakhstan's budding economic and security relationship with the PRC is deeply concerning to the Foreign Minister and the President. Therefore, the delegation is directed to collect all available information on Kazakhstan's plans to invigorate that relationship. Kazakh military equipment is aging and could be replaced with modern Russian equipment of far higher quality. If Kazakhstan is willing to trade their older equipment for credit toward modern Russian arms, the delegation is authorized to explore such an arrangement but make no final agreements. Finally, Kazakhstan is embracing a stronger economic, and more troubling, security partnership with Uzbekistan, a nation no longer a signatory to the CSTO. Russia views this initiative by Kazakhstan as unwise and concerning. Privately communicating that position to the Kazakh delegation is directed. Report back to the Foreign Minister any information acquired regarding these initiatives, whether they be bilaterally between Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan, or multilaterally between Kazakhstan, Uzbekistan, and any other nation in attendance at the summit.

KYRGYZSTAN

Kyrgyzstan remains a steadfast member of the CSTO and the Eurasian Economic Union. The Kyrgyz economy is suffering because of a massive trade deficit with the PRC, and the delegation is directed to pursue greater participation by the Kyrgyz Republic in the Union rather than continuing to suboptimize their economic future by selling out to the PRC. Identify any Kyrgyz economic needs through bilateral discussions, and report back immediately to the Foreign Minister if any indications exist the Kyrgyz Republic will seek to change their standing in either the CSTO or the Eurasian Economic Union. Kyrgyzstan is also facing the need to upgrade their military capabilities. The delegation should ascertain what needs the Kyrgyz delegation is willing to share regarding what kind of military upgrades are desired, and quantities needed for aircraft (fixed wing and rotary wing), armor and armored vehicles, artillery, communications, electronic warfare, et al. A final agreement must be coordinated later, but identifying needs at this summit, during private, bilateral discussions, would help to expedite delivery of new armaments in a timely manner, enhancing the Kyrgyz Republic's security profile. Finally, we are open to whatever additional ideas the Kyrgyz delegation may offer to our delegation. The delegation is authorized to pursue opportunities expeditiously, should they arise, but except for items already identified above, final agreements must be signed later between the foreign ministers for both nations.

TAJIKISTAN

Tajikistan remains a stalwart friend to Russia. The delegation is directed to offer security assistance to the Tajik delegation considering recent separatist and terrorist challenges to the government, and the export of terrorism abroad, most specifically to Russia. The Moscow attack that took the lives of so many must have a just outcome, including support from the Tajik authorities to break apart that terror group and to deliver the planners and surviving perpetrators to Russia for trial. The delegation must insist on this point with the Tajik delegation, but, and this must be stressed, only during bilateral talks. If the Tajik

government is interested in security assistance in the form of intelligence or military personnel supporting Tajik operations inside Tajikistan, such an arrangement is authorized, and the delegation may work out the details directly with the Tajik delegation. Tajikistan also remains one of the poorest nations in Central Asia, and we would welcome the nation into the Eurasian Economic Union. Tajik natural resources that might be exported to Russia for manufacturing, et al, would be welcome, as would a significant expansion of Tajik citizens on guest worker visas. The delegation is also authorized to discuss this opportunity directly with the Tajik delegation, but a final agreement must be signed later after both foreign ministries have considered all impacts of such an economic agreement. Tajikistan is in, perhaps, the weakest position to argue for their own territorial integrity and protection of their rightful natural resources—specifically water resources. The delegation should communicate, privately, our full support for maintaining Tajikistan’s current borders and water resources, including technical assistance for upgraded water infrastructure, if desired, and the delegation is encouraged to highlight a quid-pro-quo for Russian support in this regard matching our policy proposals identified above.

UZBEKISTAN

Uzbekistan remains a contentious challenge for us. Though there is no reason for open hostility toward the country’s delegation, our delegation is encouraged to deliver a subtle warning about Uzbekistan turning too rapidly toward the West, or in the pursuit of any regional organizations that do not include us as a key policymaker in such a construct. Security partnerships between Uzbekistan and other nations, especially western nations, are particularly concerning and if the delegation determines there is any movement in this direction, you are to inform the Foreign Minister immediately with all available details. Of particular concern would be Uzbekistan purchasing arms from European or American arms manufacturers. It is conceivable they may choose to upgrade their armed forces using Indian, or, more likely, Chinese arms, and while that is of a far lesser concern, the Foreign Minister should still be informed immediately. Uzbekistan is likely to focus entirely on border issues and water resources and may offer water resource sharing schemes. We withhold judgement on these issues about Uzbekistan, but once the delegation has ascertained Uzbekistan’s position on these two issues, report your findings to the Foreign Minister and await further guidance. Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan are both in great need of freshwater resources. The delegation may offer to broker an arrangement wherein we intercede on Uzbekistan’s behalf to work collaboratively with Kazakhstan to create a water desalination facility on the Caspian Sea that would deliver freshwater resources to the western regions of both nations. We have made breakthroughs in this technology in recent years and is willing to collaborate on such an initiative. Finally, Uzbekistan has the largest population and most diversified economy among the five Central Asian nations. We encourage Uzbekistan to work collaboratively with us to seek export markets for Uzbekistan’s natural resources. Particularly with oil and natural gas, our pipeline infrastructure is robust and can be further expanded to deliver both commodities to western markets. The delegation is authorized to explore cost sharing and revenue sharing schemes with the Uzbek delegation if this option proves amenable to the Uzbeks.

PEOPLE’S REPUBLIC OF CHINA

The People’s Republic of China has become a key strategic partner to the Russian Federation. Chinese assistance, both in providing critical technologies and resources, and in

brokering a renewed relationship with the Democratic People's Republic of Korea, have proven vital to the conflict against Ukraine. The delegation is directed to deliver that message to the Chinese delegation and to offer negotiation assistance as needed to present a united front in dealing with the crisis in Central Asia. However, our many decades of partnership and friendship with India place the delegation in a conundrum. While simultaneously working closely with India and China will be challenging, as it is likely the two nations will have very different objectives at the summit, our delegation is directed to make the best of the situation. It may prove useful to find ways to play the two delegations against one another and then to serve as a trusted mediator to enhance our negotiating positions across all areas. Wherever possible, try to get support from both nations to achieve our intentions for this crisis summit. The key Red Line for China's activities at the summit would be if the delegation detects China making a play to insert itself into a leadership role in Central Asia, which is a critical part of our near abroad. The Foreign Ministry has received reliable intelligence that China wishes to open a military facility in Tajikistan - this must be opposed, though not at the expense of a strategic partnership between Moscow and Beijing. Gather all available information on this effort and communicate back to the Foreign Minister immediately if China pushes for hegemonic roles in Central Asia. Regarding intelligence sharing with China, the PRC faces internal security challenges that mirror ours. Therefore, the delegation is authorized to explore ways in which we and China may deepen cooperation for intelligence sharing to protect both nations' security interests.

INDIA

India is one of the Russian Federation's long-term friends in a challenging region. While no competition for influence in Central Asia exists between India and us, India does have serious concerns regarding the PRC's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI). The delegation is directed to ascertain India's list of concerns regarding BRI, and to inquire about ways in which we may be able to intercede on India's behalf with China, or the Central Asian nations. It is well known that India has a special relationship with Tajikistan going back many decades, including military cooperation, specifically in air force cooperation in training and maintenance. The delegation is directed to encourage India to rejuvenate this arrangement with Tajikistan as a counterbalance to Chinese influence across Central Asia, which is a growing concern for us. These topics should only be discussed privately in bilateral talks with the Indian delegation. Regarding defense cooperation, India has purchased Russian arms many times in the past and has also developed their own significant arms industry. The delegation is directed to inquire about cooperative defense initiatives between India and us in the areas of cyber security, artificial intelligence, quantum computing, ballistic missile technology, directed energy weapons, and in submarine, surface combatant, and aviation platforms and weapons systems associated with all three. The delegation is not authorized to finalize any agreements but rather is directed to develop a list of needs or interests, and as is authorized to consider a negotiation framework for this area, to be concluded later by foreign ministry and defense ministry negotiators. Finally, the Indian delegation may seek to improve intelligence sharing regarding Central Asia, particular around terrorism and separatist movements. The delegation may enter negotiations to build a framework for such an agreement but make no commitments for us in this regard. Any intelligence sharing beyond these threats must be negotiated separately by senior defense officials. If India wishes to negotiate an

agreement to share intelligence on PRC political or economic issues, or on PLA topics, the delegation may cooperatively build a framework for such sensitive issues, but the final agreement must be deeply considered, and any signing of an agreement will happen later. The sensitivity of this topic regarding China should be obvious. Only the Head of Delegation may discuss these sensitive issues with the Indian Head of Delegation, and it should be done privately in a bilateral session.

There may be times when the Foreign Minister is unable to respond immediately to your communication. Under those circumstances, the delegation should proceed as directed in this guidance.